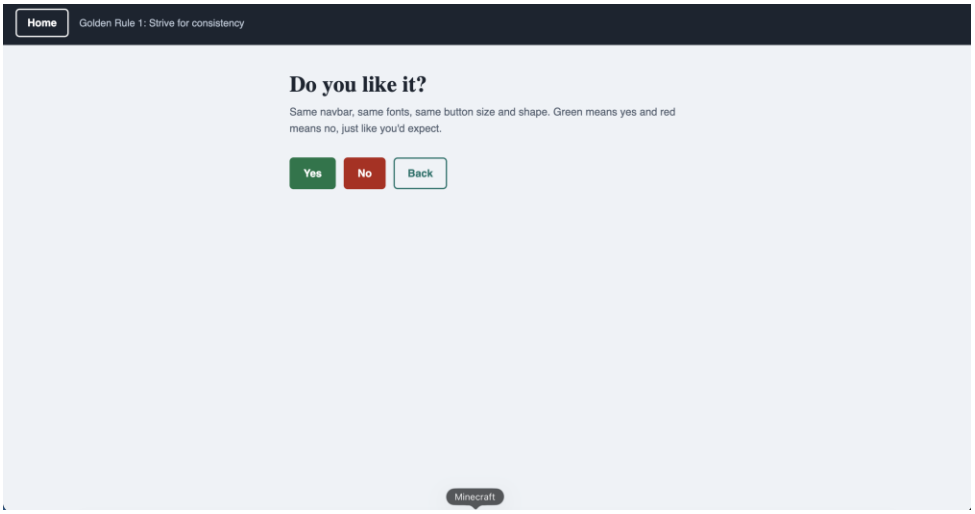
Rule: Strive for Consistency





For this page, the user is meant to choose between a consistent and an inconsistent version of the same screen and compare how each one feels to use. The start screen and the consistent page share the same navbar, fonts, and button style. The consistent page keeps the color meanings people expect, with a green Yes and a red No of the same size and shape, and the “Back” button uses the same wording and style as the other buttons. The inconsistent page breaks each of these on purpose. Its navbar has a different color, its links use mismatched fonts and sizes, and the back option is worded two different ways (“go back?” and “Back”). The question’s buttons also reverse the usual color and size conventions, with a large red Yes and a small green No. The No button also jumps to a new spot with each of its first three clicks, and the prompts “Really?” and “Why not?” appear before the explanation. Because nothing on the page looks or behaves the same way twice, the user can’t predict what an element will do. This is the contrast that shows consistency supports the rule. Finally, the message shown after the user clicks Yes or No gives feedback that explains why the page felt easy or confusing.